CONF42 • PROMPT ENGINEERING

Beyond Better Prompts

Designing Reliable Prompt Engineering Workflows for Production AI

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A good response is not proof

One prompt. One impressive answer. Many unanswered questions.

Demo success ≠ reliable performance

Three levels: prompt to workflow

PROMPTING → PROMPT ENGINEERING → PROMPT WORKFLOW

Ask → Design deliberately → Test and improve systematically

Start with a testable task

VAGUE: “Build a login page.”

BETTER: “Build a React + TypeScript login form with field validation, accessible labels, error states and reusable components.”

Context changes the result

The model needs the right project information

Relevant files • Existing conventions • Dependencies • Current requirements

Structure the prompt for reuse

TASK | CONTEXT | CONSTRAINTS | OUTPUT

A reusable template is easier to test than a one-off message

Design a prompt workflow

DEFINE → PROVIDE CONTEXT → GENERATE → EVALUATE → REFINE

The evaluation result feeds the next prompt version

Test more than the happy path

NORMAL | MISSING INPUT | EDGE CASE | ADVERSARIAL

One successful example cannot establish reliability

Evaluate what actually matters

Correctness • Requirement coverage • Format • Consistency

Use clear criteria, not “this looks good to me”

Security is part of prompt reliability

Untrusted input must not override trusted instructions

Prompt injection • Sensitive data • Unsafe tool requests

Compare prompt versions, not impressions

v1: Basic instructions constraints

v2: Added context and

Run the same evaluation set before accepting a change

Prompt drift and regression

Requirements, context and models change over time

A previously reliable prompt can become less reliable

Production: monitor the prompt behaviour

Quality • Failures • Latency • Cost • Safety

Use real patterns to improve the evaluation set

A practical workflow you can reuse

1 DEFINE 2 CONTEXT 3 TEMPLATE 4 TEST 5 EVALUATE 6 VERSION

Repeat when prompts, models or requirements change

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Build prompt workflows, not prompt collections

Design → Test → Evaluate → Improve

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